

consultIQ

Brand Style Guidelines

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Visual Identity & Interface Standards

ConsultIQ is a consultant placement platform that helps consultancy firms place the right consultant on the right project. Its interface must communicate authority, precision, and trust – qualities that reflect both the diligence and precision of its matching algorithm and the professionalism expected by enterprise clients.

This brand style guide defines the visual language that governs all ConsultIQ interfaces, design assets, and communications. Adherence ensures a consistent, accessible, and professional user experience across every touchpoint of the system.

Core Design Principles

The six foundational pillars guiding every UI and UX decision within ConsultIQ.



Clarity

Every interface element communicates its purpose instantly. Labels, data displays, and interactions require no guesswork.



Consistency

Visual patterns, component behaviours, and terminology remain uniform across all views and user roles.



Authority

The interface projects confidence and competence, reinforcing trust in placement recommendations and scoring outputs.



Simplicity

Complexity is hidden behind clean interfaces. The matching engine's sophistication is felt in results, not visual clutter.



Responsiveness

Layouts adapt gracefully to desktop, tablet, and mobile viewports without loss of functionality or legibility.



Accessibility

Strict WCAG 2.2 AA conformance ensures no feature or content is inaccessible to users of diverse abilities.

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Color Architecture

The ConsultIQ palette relies on enterprise deep navy and steel blue tones to project authority and precision, paired with a gold accent for quality indicators. All combinations are validated for WCAG 2.2 AA contrast compliance.

1. Primary Brand Palette

Core Identity

AAA Compliant (14.2:1)

#002D62

--color-primary

Dark Blue (Primary)

Primary navigation, hero sections, primary buttons, page headers

rgb(0, 45, 98)

AA Compliant (5.8:1)

#3C5A8A

--color-secondary

Blue (Secondary)

Secondary buttons, active tab indicators, hover states, subheadings

rgb(60, 90, 138)

AAA Compliant (7.1:1)

#C9A84C

--color-accent

Gold (Accent)

Highlighted text, active tab indicators

rgb(201, 168, 76)

2. Neutrals & Surfaces

Structure & Content

AAA Compliant (15.1:1)

#F4F6FA

--color-surface

Surface

AAA Compliant (16.7:1)

#FFFFFF

--color-white

Card & Modal Surface

AA Compliant (N/A)

#E2E8F0

--color-border

Border Subtle

Main page body background, card containers, subtle panels

rgb(244, 246, 250)

Card background surfaces, modal panels, input backgrounds

rgb(255, 255, 255)

Divider lines, card borders, input field outlines

rgb(226, 232, 240)

AAA Compliant (7.2:1)

#4A5568

--color-dark-grey

Dark Grey

Secondary labels, dark surface body copy, footer meta text

rgb(74, 85, 104)

AAA Compliant (16.7:1)

#1F2937

--color-text-primary

Body Text Primary

Primary body text, table content, form input labels

rgb(31, 41, 55)

AA Compliant (4.6:1)

#6B7280

--color-text-secondary

Text Secondary / Muted

Helper text, disabled icons, metadata timestamps, placeholders

rgb(107, 114, 128)

3. System Feedback & Status

Structure & Content

AA Compliant (4.8:1)

#16A34A

--color-success

Success

Match confirmed, successful profile creation, active consultant tag

rgb(22, 163, 74)

AA Compliant (3.2:1)

#F59E0B

--color-warning

Warning

Missing profile fields, contract expiring soon, partial skill match

rgb(245, 158, 11)

AA Compliant (5.4:1)

#B91C1C

--color-danger

Danger

Remove consultant, delete project, API execution error alerts

rgb(185, 28, 28)

Typography System

The ConsultIQ typographic hierarchy utilizes clean, high-legibility sans-serif typefaces optimized for data-dense dashboards and enterprise reporting workflows.



Primary Sans-Serif
`var(--font-primary)`

Aa Bb Cc 123

Used for all interface controls, headings, body text, and interactive buttons.



Monospace Code
`var(--font-mono)`

0123 % >

Reserved for score calculations, code blocks, and tabular metrics.

Type Scale Hierarchy

Display /H1 2.5rem (40px) Weight: 700 (Bold)

Consultant Scoring Engine

Line Height: 1.2 Letter Spacing: -0.02em Usage: Headers, Section title

Heading 2 /H2 2.0rem (32px) Weight: 700 (Bold)

Algorithm Configurations

Line Height: 1.25 Letter Spacing: -0.01em Usage: Card modal titles

Heading 3 /H3 1.5rem (24px) Weight: 600 (Semibold)

Top Matches

Line Height: 1.3 Letter Spacing: normal Usage: Table headers

Heading 4 /H4 1.25rem (20px) Weight: 600 (Semibold)

Project Name

Line Height: 1.4 Letter Spacing: normal Usage: Secondary label

Body Base 1.0rem (16px) Weight: 400 (Regular)

Enter email

Line Height: 1.5 Letter Spacing: normal Usage: Form input contents

Body Small /Caption 0.875rem (16px) Weight: 400 (Regular)

Profule created!

Line Height: 1.4 Letter Spacing: 0.01em Usage: Helper text

Spacing & Design Tokens

Systematic spatial metrics ensure structural alignment, consistent component rhythm, and predictable responsive layouts across the ConsultIQ platform.



1. Spatial Grid System

Based on an 8-point rhythm scale.

--space-xs	0.25rem	(4px)		Icon gap , badge padding
--space-sm	0.5rem	(8px)		Button inline padding , input gaps
--space-md	1.0rem	(16px)		Card padding , form layout spacing
--space-lg	1.5rem	(24px)		Section margins , modal padding
--space-xl	2.0rem	(32px)		Dashboard stats grid gap , major section dividers
--space-2xl	3.0rem	(48px)		Hero section padding , page margins



2. Border Radii

Standardized corner curvature tokens.

--radius-sm

(6px)

0.375rem

Input fields and small tag pills

--radius-md

(8px)

0.5rem

Standard buttons and dropdown menus

--radius-lg

(12px)

0.75rem

Content cards

--radius-xl

(16px)

1.0rem

Modals and floating panel containers

Iconography System

ConsultIQ utilizes line-based icons from the Lucide library to maintain technical clarity and consistent visual weight across all interface screens.

Standard Icon Scales

Inline16px



Inline metadata, status indicators

Button / Standard20px



Action buttons, dropdown triggers, input adornments

Navigation24px



Sidebar items, card actions

Feature Highlight32px



Modal headers, landing cards

Logo Requirements

- Standalone icons without text labels **must** include an explicit `aria-label` attribute.
- Decorative icons placed next to text should use `aria-hidden="true"`.
- Icons must follow the same contrast rules as body text: dark navy on light surfaces and white on navy surfaces

Forbidden Treatments

- Do not fill icons with solid colors unless denoting an active/selected tab state.
- Never stretch or alter the native aspect ratio of icons.
- Avoid adding heavy drop-shadows or outer glows directly onto line icons.

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UI Voice & Copywriting Tone

Guidance on writing clear, actionable, and professional microcopy for buttons, empty states system tooltips, and diagnostic error alerts

PILLAR 1

Authoritative & Direct

Maintain professional enterprise tone. Avoid casual language, slang, or excessive jargon.

PILLAR 2

Concise & Efficient

UI labels must communicate their purpose in as few words as possible without sacrificing clarity.

PILLAR 3

Actionable Error Handling

Error messages must state what went wrong and provide explicit steps to resolve the issue.

Microcopy Comparison Matrix

⊗ Avoid vague and unhelpful error messages

Something went wrong while fetching consultants. Please try again later.

Fails to specify why the request failed and leaves the user without an immediate solution.

☑ Actionable

Unable to retrieve consultants: try adhusting filter parameters.

Identifies the error context clearly and suggests actionable next steps to recover.

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Logo System

1. OFFICIAL LOGO VARIANTS



Standard Logo

Used on white or light surface backgrounds.



Dark Logo

Used on deep navy or dark backgrounds.

2. USAGE SPECIFICATIONS

Minimum Size

Digital interface min width: **120px** (Absolute min: **80px**).

Prohibited Use

Do not stretch, recolor with unapproved gradients, or apply drop shadows.

Changelog (Demo 1 to Demo 2)

PRIMARY BUTTON COLOR UPDATE

Updated

Demo 1: Accent Gold (#C9A84C)

→

Demo 2: Primary Navy (#002D62)

✔

Rationale: Switched primary buttons to Primary Navy (`#002D62`) for better WCAG AAA contrast compliance, reserving Accent Gold strictly for highlights and focus indicators.